



Course Evaluations Fall 2023, period 2

Course Director Report 5304 Econometrics



Report prepared by **Quality Assurance**
Created **Wednesday, January 17, 2024**



Courses Audience: 60
Responses Received: 36
Response Ratio: 60.0%

Report Comments

The content of this report is intended for the course director. Please be cautious when discussing the results and do not distribute the report outside the School. The Stockholm School of Economics is committed to ensuring the protection of personal data and the integrity of students and employees.

All ratings are on a scale from 1 to 7, where 1 is “disagree strongly” and 7 is “agree strongly”.

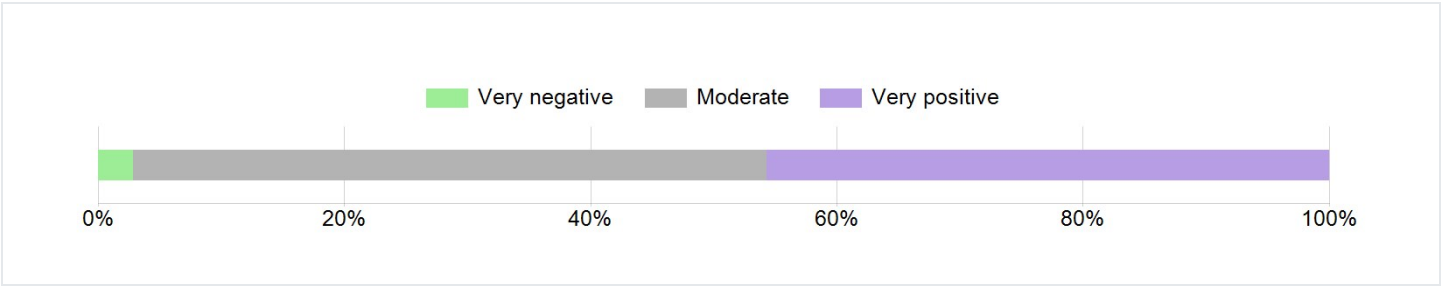
The total teacher average is calculated regardless of the number of responses to each question. This means that the three teacher-related questions have the same weight.

N.B. If there are course feedback surveys closing after the end of the current study period, this report might be updated.

If this report is for a mandatory course in one of SSE's programs, this report will also be shared with the program director directly.

Please contact SSEquality@hhs.se if you have any questions.

Course Satisfaction (scale distribution)



Course Satisfaction

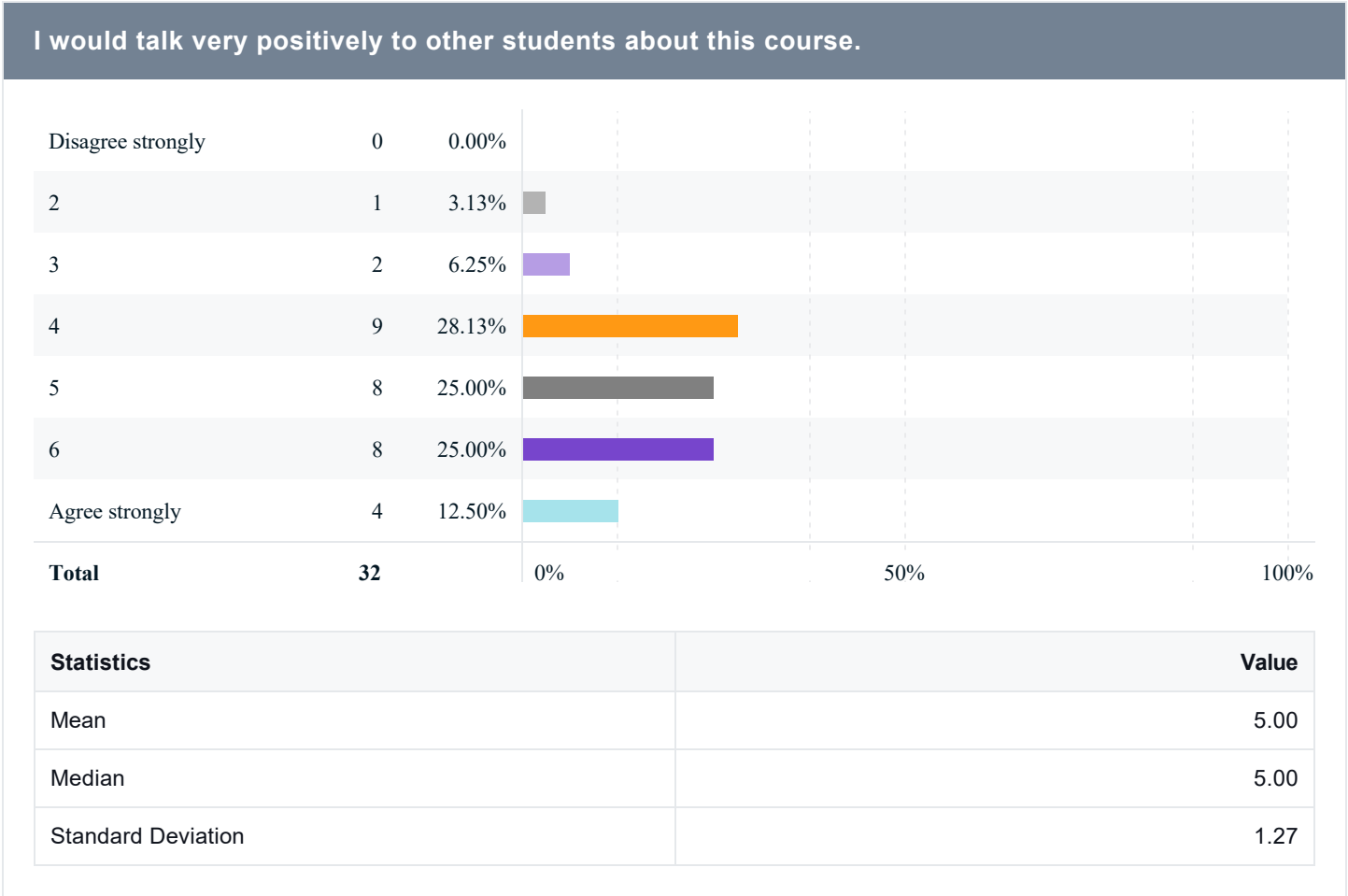
Overall, I am satisfied with the quality of this course.

Disagree strongly	0	0.00%	
2	1	2.86%	
3	1	2.86%	
4	8	22.86%	
5	9	25.71%	
6	12	34.29%	
Agree strongly	4	11.43%	
Total	35	0%	100%

Statistics	Value
Mean	5.20
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	1.18

SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Fall 23	5.27	1.48	2129

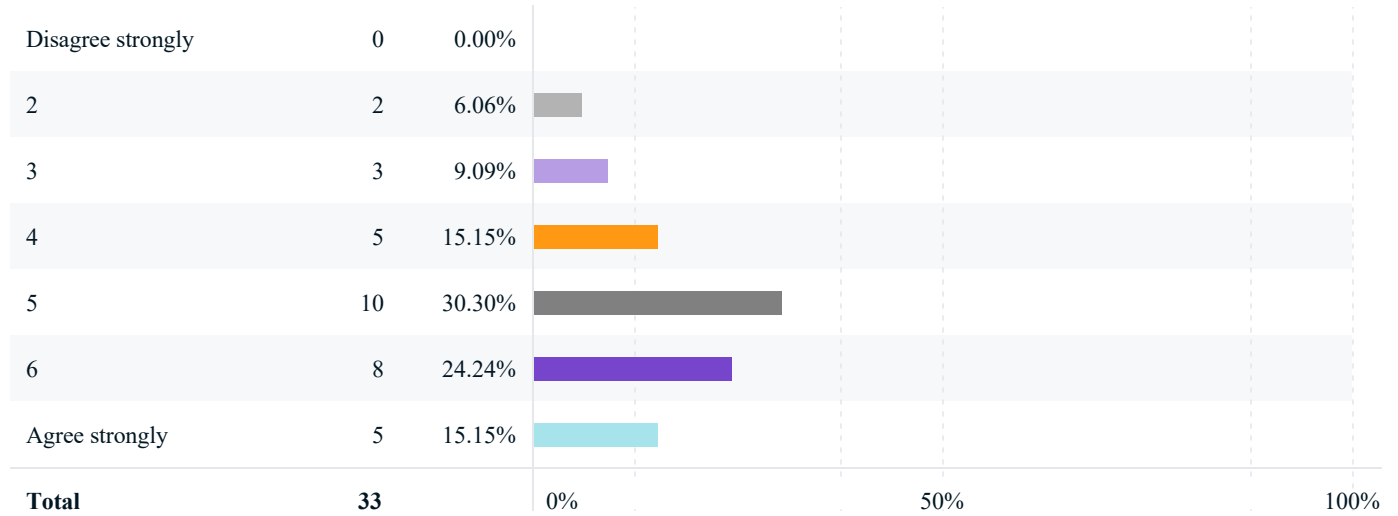
I would talk very positively to other students about this course.



SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Fall 23	5.23	1.58	2053

Course Material

The course material (literature, lecture notes, videos, cases, etc.) effectively contributed to my learning.



Statistics	Value
Mean	5.03
Median	5.00
Standard Deviation	1.40

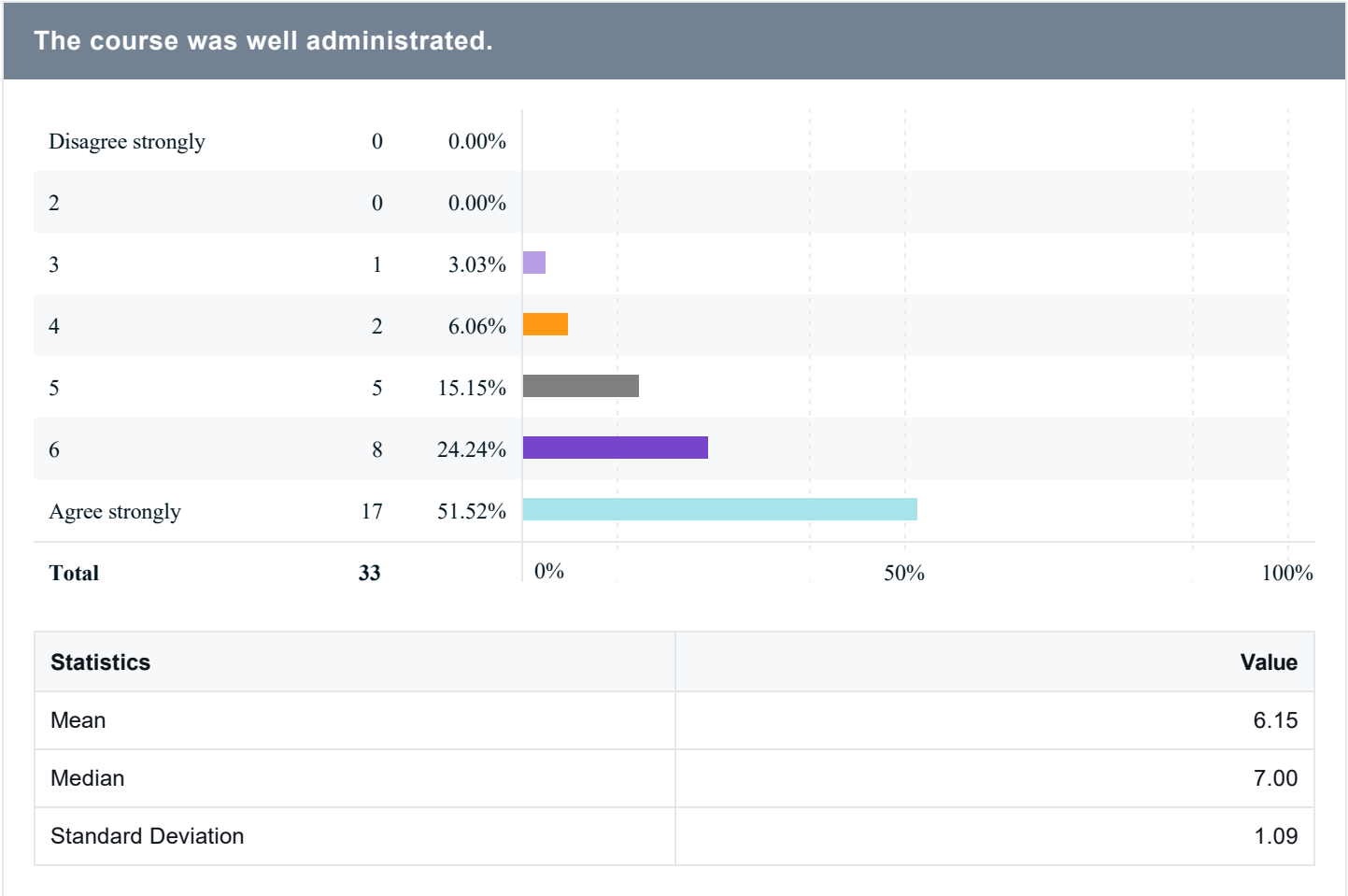
SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Fall 23	5.22	1.52	2062

Time Spent on Course



SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Fall 23	5.37	1.36	2052

Administration



SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Fall 23	5.62	1.44	2046

Do you have any specific feedback on the course administration?

Comments
Very good of the professor to use announcements extensively to keep us informed of each lecture.
I believe there is nothing to improve under this aspect.
It was great!
I think the administration worked very well.
Went smoothly
No

What were the strengths of this course? Please be specific and use concrete examples where possible.

Comments
Overall really structured, and information was always published on time
Enthusiastic teacher
I believe that having to do the problem sets was essential for the understanding of the course content. Not only they incentivized keeping up with the content covered, they also made me realize what I had actually understood and what I only got the gist of.
Jaakko is a great teacher, he is well-prepared, very structured and organized, he even takes the time to summarize each lecture at the end and post a canvas announcement, he is kind and helpful
The quality of the seminars and thoroughness of lectures, Jaakko sees so everyone follows.
A lot of examples and a very applied approach. Also, the assignments and seminars were a really good practice.
The course is a good introduction to Econometrics and covers very relevant subjects.
Jakko is one of the kindest and most compassionate teachers that I have ever had. It really feels like he cares about us students and he always takes the time to answer all of our questions in and outside of the classroom. The teacher assistant is also absolutely phenomenal and contributed to my learning tremendously. He deserves a raise.
This course has covered the most common econometric methods and the very important basics to know about. Useful for execute and understand research.
The lectures and seminars were very good, both Jaakko and Petter are very good teachers. They take their time to explain and help students. Jaakko also provided good information during the whole course. I especially appreciated the summary after every lecture.
1. The course covers most of the key methods in econometrics (OLS, IVs, RDD, Diff-in-Diffs). Although I wish some of the topics could have been discussed in more detail (more on this in my answer to the next question), I am also aware that this is a 7-week course and we have quite a lot of ground to cover already. 2. Jaakko is such a kind person. It would have been so much worse if he hadn't been so supportive!
The topics covered throughout the course were interesting and useful. Research papers discussed during the lectures helped to understand the content better. Office hours were much appreciated.
The focus on applied econometrics was nice since it feels the most relevant. Statistical software solves most of the technical aspects nowadays anyway, so the course focused on the most important parts, I felt.
The main goal of the course is very clear. Various examples are provided.
Jaakko is very engaged, motivated and kind! One could see that he truly cares for the students. Furthermore, he has a very good knowledge of the subject and illustrates it perfectly with research examples.
It was great that the course was so applied. This really helped understand the subject.
I found the most strongest part of the course was the applications of the econometric tools that we got to know. For instance, when we in the lectures got the opportunity to see how researchers actually used the methods for research purposes as well as in the group assignments.
Also, very nice memes!

Comments

Engaged teaching staff, relevant problem sets covering both hands-on data analysis and interpretation exercises.

First off, it teaches how to analyze a published economic paper. I find it particularly fascinating: after this course, I feel like I can indeed have my opinion on the paper I am looking at, understanding whether or not it is reliable. Of course, all on a small scale: the road to fully be able to spot weaknesses and strengths is still very long but I am glad that I acquired the basic tools for analyzing and having an understanding of the methodologies employed.

Second, we analyze many different methodologies which are very useful. I find the following the most interesting thing I learnt: realizing that econometrics tackles a variety of problems and consequently the good researcher has a variety of methodologies that from which she/he can choose from. Indeed, it is not just about a linear regression, there is a whole world of possibilities out there! It might seem obvious, but I personally never really studied in detail any of the other methodologies and therefore I was very pleased to expand my knowledge on this! My personal favorite? Instrumental variables: they can be used in very different contexts and combined with other methodologies providing a solution for situations in which it would be quite difficult otherwise (even if understanding their relevance and validity is surely challenging, as the analysis of the paper showed us!).

Applied to real case problems

It provided theoretical and applied knowledge

It also provided lots of examples of papers from different backgrounds which helped me understand how and when to apply each method for different set-ups, which is extremely useful for writing the thesis

The TA and the professor were extremely committed to the course and supporting students. Both complement each other, so if I couldn't understand something in class, I could always ask during the seminar, and vice-versa.

–Problem sets

–Seminars

Good to practically apply the knowledge.

This course was a great balance between theory and application. I liked how each method was discussed with an example of a paper that used it.

A lot of examples in the lecture

Good overview of econometric methods

Many practical examples

The TA and the take home assignments. The exam (layout)

The topics are interesting and relevant. I.e how to apply/use RDD, DiD and IV

How could this course be improved? Please be specific and use concrete examples where possible.

Comments

Make it easier to approach for beginners by having a more thorough introduction to econometrics. Explain concepts more in details with the logic/intuition behind it, and not just the math formulas behind a concept, as not everyone understands concepts thanks to the math.

I believe that using the white board more, instead of mostly relying on the slides, would ease understanding significantly. I say this because by seeing how formulas are derived at a slower speed than if written on a slide allows me to reason at a more comfortable pace.

NA

It was noticeable in the slides that Jaakko had inherited the course, hence the course will be better the more he gets used to the material or makes the material his own. Slides which towards the end of the course were better than in the beginning.

Even though allowing for almost endless amounts of questions is a luxury I do not want to discourage, the lecture time is scarce. It would, at times, have felt better to have properly finished a segment during a lecture, rather than leaving it not properly finished. And this could perhaps be better accommodated if questions could at least sometimes be saved for later, after we have gone over the whole thing. It sometimes felt like people took advantage of the generosity by asking a lot of things that I believe would be answered later naturally, hence using up the time to fully finish things.

The main problem with this course is related to what is included. It is almost identical to the econometrics course that is mandatory for specializing in Economics for Bachelor students in SSE. I realize that this might be unavoidable given that it is hard to require that all new students have taken similar courses before their master, but it feels very disheartening to study a course where about 80 % of the material is not new. Thus, my lower grade on the course is mostly a reflection on the material covered. It is not really fun to spend a fourth of the first semester on repetition.

It would be good if it would be made a bit more clear which parts of the course material is relevant for the exam/exercises. During class a lot of time is spent on mathematical deductions which isn't really used in the previous exams or problem sets. More old exams WITH solutions would also be great.

It would have been great to have an introduction course in econometrics during the summer. This is mainly due to two reasons. For students from SSE, this course is very similar to the bachelor econometrics specialization course and a lot of the content is the same, which means that previous SSE bachelor students do not learn that many new concepts from this course. Having an introduction course can allow the SSE students to review the old concepts. The second reason is that for students coming from other countries or universities, they might have covered less econometrics during their bachelors and it would be better for their understanding of the course to have an introduction course. Together, this will allow the professor to cover more advanced econometric methods in this formal course.

However, unfortunately the exam was too long, it was extremely stressful. I did not have time to finish all the questions, neither to read the questions I answered properly, there was too much new information to read on the exam and too little time to answer properly. Either it would have been appropriate to have a take home exam on that lasted the whole day with that much material or make it shorter. As someone who has been writing a lot of exams and never had any problems, this was the most stressful four hours of my life. Regarding this, all else has been very good during the course and I have no complaint at all.

I don't know how it can be solved, but to me it feels that the course bit off more than it could chew. I simply do not think 7 weeks is enough to cover that much material without jeopardizing depth. Like I said in the "strengths" part above, many key topics were rushed through, like sampling variance, conditional mean independence, the MLR assumptions, etc. which in my opinion are the building blocks for most econometric methods. As a result, I had a hard time trying to understand the theories behind the identification strategies in the later parts of the course. That being said, I still think it's a very good course with huge potential. I learned a lot from it!

Comments

The course lacked clarity regarding examinable material. The lectures covered many topics, and at times, they felt rushed and lacked in-depth analysis. The format, structure, and length of the exam were not clear enough, which led to many questions and confusion close to the exam. Overall, it was hard to know what to expect from the exam and how to prepare for it.

Sometimes it felt that Jaakko was not very familiar with the material, which makes sense since it is the first time he teaches the course. There is nevertheless some room for improvement in that department.

During class, the structure of the lectures was sometimes a little bit chaotic switching back and forth between slides and having a long review part at the beginning of each session.

I went to SSE in my Bachelor's, and I think there was considerable overlap between this course and Robert's course in econometrics at the Bachelor level. Considering that the slides of Robert's course were prerequisites for even attending the program, I feel like there perhaps should have been less focus on the tools themselves and even more on their practical and research applications as. For most of the course, it mostly felt like repetition from the Bachelor's and not really an "upgrade" to a Master's level – however that could of course be because of Robert's excellence as a teacher and not the level of this course. With that said, I still understand the need to "get people on the same level".

Just as an example, we had already covered most all of the more advanced tools such as IV, DiD and RDD with Robert and it felt quite repetitive going through them again (even though it is the case that repetitio est mater studiorum).

Also! One thing that could be good would be to use more pictures and gifs when explaining things like attenuation bias. It helps tremendously in the learning! Here is a link to an excellent thread on X that Robert posted a while back:
<https://x.com/robertostling/status/1494418738547933185?s=20>

If you do not dare to click on a link in an anonymously answered survey, just search for something like "Twitter Robert Östling gifs attenuation bias classic measurement error #EconTwitter" and they will show up on Google.

Feel like the lectures did not always focus on the most important material. Would have appreciated a more in-depth discussion of core topics. Also did not gain too much from the empirical examples covered in class.

It could be useful to spend more time on the last two lectures that were quite close to the exam day, leaving little time to internalize the content

The content of the course is dense, so sometimes it felt that we were covering a lot of information in a very short time.

Perhaps extend the exam slightly, or remove some questions on the exam.
My understanding (which could be wrong!), is that most students did not have time to finish.

The course's organization could be improved, particularly in the building of the slide decks. I found it difficult to determine what things were most important to the course: some of the slides within the slide decks went much further with notation/theory and were for people who were interested in digging deeper– perhaps these slides could be posted separately. Additionally, some things that seemed important to the course (like the conditional mean independence assumption) felt like a subpoint in the slides rather than a main finding. Lastly, I prefer slides to be grouped by topic rather than lecture– if I need to review some specific aspect of instrumental variables, I would much prefer to open the IV slides and look there than try and remember which lecture number it was when we covered the topic. I think this also makes it a bit less confusing when we don't cover everything planned for one lecture or when we get a bit ahead.

Sometimes, the theory should be stated more clearly before introducing examples.

A bit more theory

More use of statistical software

Improve the teaching method. Less heavy slides and more explanations.

Structure could be much better, especially the lecture slides and structure of the lectures

What would you like to tell future students about this course?

Comments
Relies heavily on a mathematical understanding of mathematics, so be prepared for that.
I think that what we learn is great and I would definitely talk positively about it. However, sometimes the explanations could be slightly clearer and less ambiguous. I say this because at times I felt like some parts of the explanations were missing and had to figure them out by myself.
Use the literature and readings to complement what Jaakko tells you in the lectures and to make sense of it
It is good, Jaakko and Petter are nice!
It is a very good course to start of master level econometrics. Some things is recognized from bachelors but it was explained much better, especially with all the examples.
Its a good and valueble course, I think most of the class share the stressful experience during the exam so i think this will be modified to next year. So I would say its a good course.
Read the books and the lecture slides!! Spending time to understand the theories will save you a lot of pain during exam prep. :)
Econometrics is fun and useful, especially if you are interested in research and data analysis. Make sure to follow lectures and prepare assigned readings. Ask questions and make use of office hours if needed.
I cannot come up with anything important.
It is good to know some matrix notation
Extremely useful for thesis. It covers the main instruments that all economists should know!
Do the problem sets and understand them in detail and attend seminars.
How you find it will depende a lot on your previous knowledge of econometrics
Interesting material but lectures a bit unstructured. Sometimes difficult to understand concepts. Could be explained more clearly

Teacher Questions

Q1: The teacher effectively advanced and facilitated my learning.
Q2: I received the help I needed from the teacher in an appropriate time frame.
Total: Overall of All Questions

If no tables are displayed in this section, no teacher-specific questions were included in the survey.

Teacher Jaakko Meriläinen

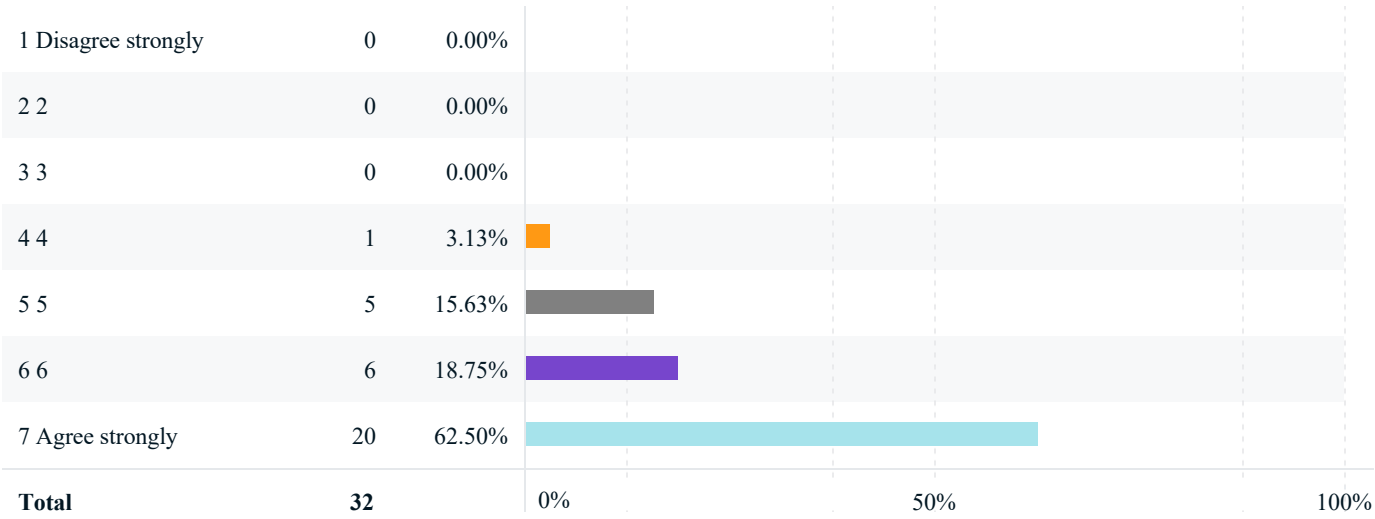
	Q1			Q2		
	Mean	SD	Resp	Mean	SD	Resp
Overall	5.35	1.25	31	6.61	0.63	28

SSE Average, Fall 23

	Q1			Q2		
	Mean	SD	Resp	Mean	SD	Resp
Overall	5.68	1.51	3201	5.94	1.40	2798

Equality and Diversity

In this course, the teacher(s) actively worked to include different people and perspectives. This was demonstrated in, for example, the selection of course materials, case studies and/or guest speakers as well as during lectures and classroom discussions through balanced speaking time and avoiding stereotypical examples.



Statistics	Value
Mean	6.41
Median	7.00
Standard Deviation	0.87

SSE Average	Mean	SD	Resp
Fall 23	5.89	1.32	1920

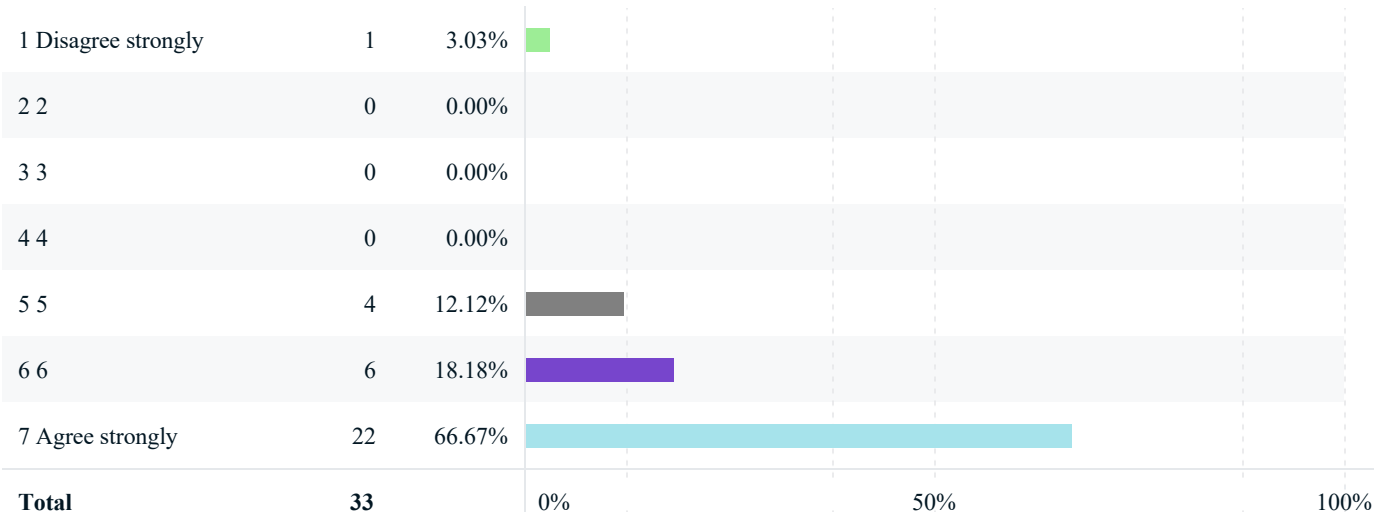
What concrete, constructive suggestions do you have for integrating a diversity, equity and inclusion perspective in this course?

Note: Course evaluations are confidential. If you would like to report a specific incident, please send an [e-mail to Karol Vieker](#), the Diversity, Equity and Inclusion Manager at SSE. Your e-mail will be handled in strict confidence. You can also use the anonymous whistleblowing tool <https://hhs.whistlelink.com/>.

Comments
None, it was perfect.
NA
Still math, gender or race plays no real role in the models themselves.
Please don't destroy this course with the radicalism and the danger to society that "diversity, equity and inclusion" represents. The memetic virus that current-day progressivism represents and the attitude it has for seeking truth can best be summarised by: "War is peace. Freedom is slavery. Ignorance is strength. "
I have no concrete, constructive suggestion.

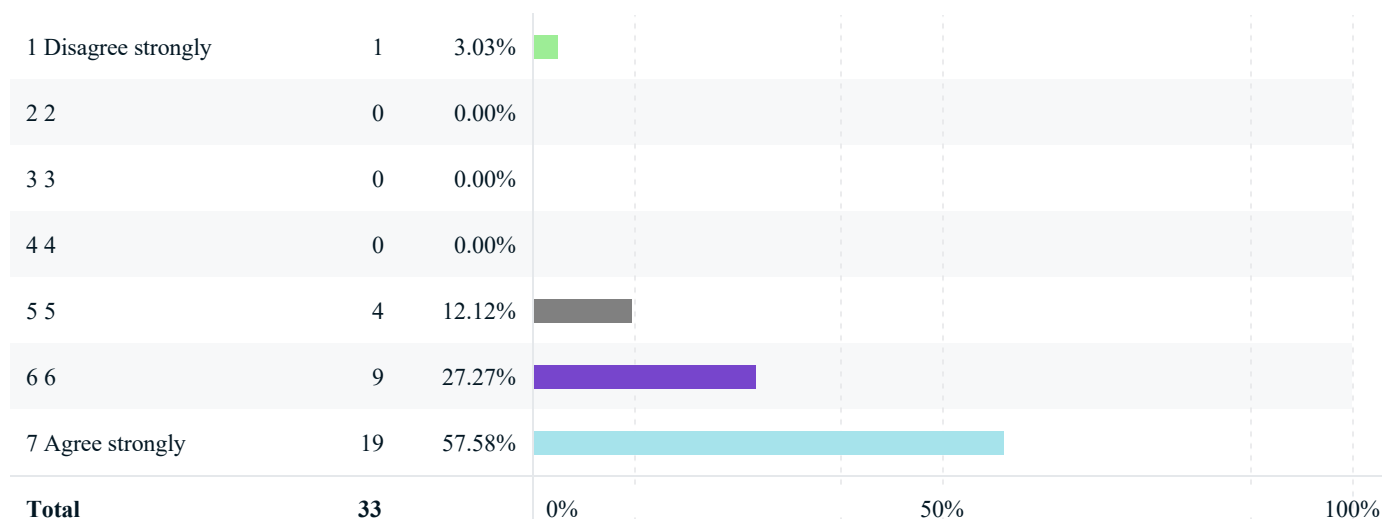
Course Questions

1. The support my teaching assistant(s) provided contributed to my learning in the course.



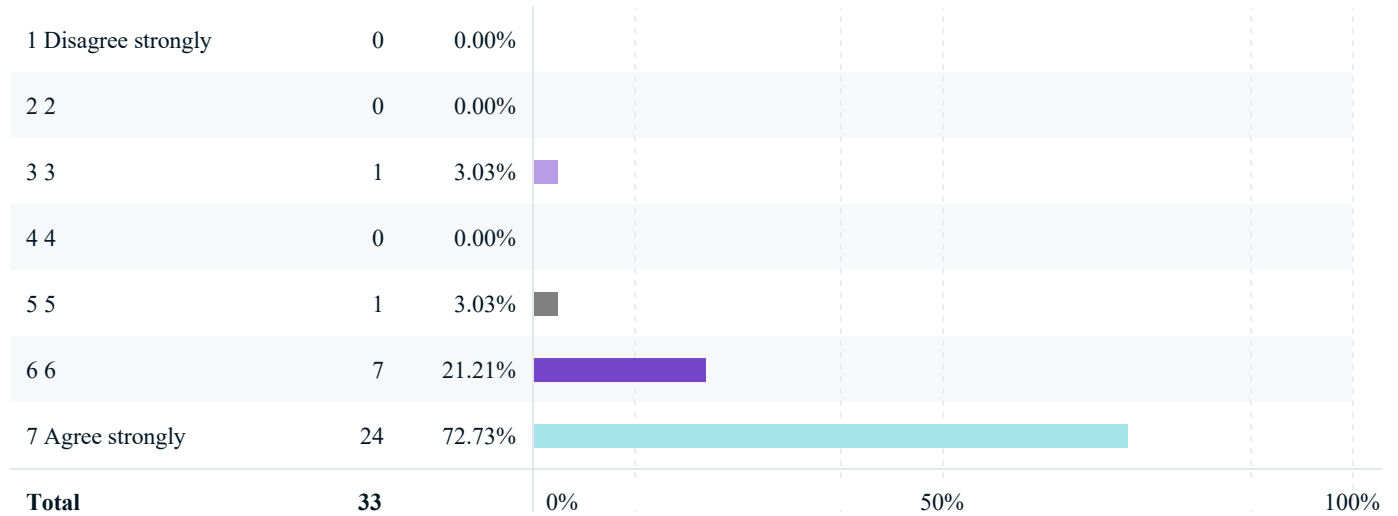
Statistics	Value
Mean	6.39
Median	7.00
Standard Deviation	1.20

2. The teaching assistant(s) drew attention to the essential skills needed to understand the course material.



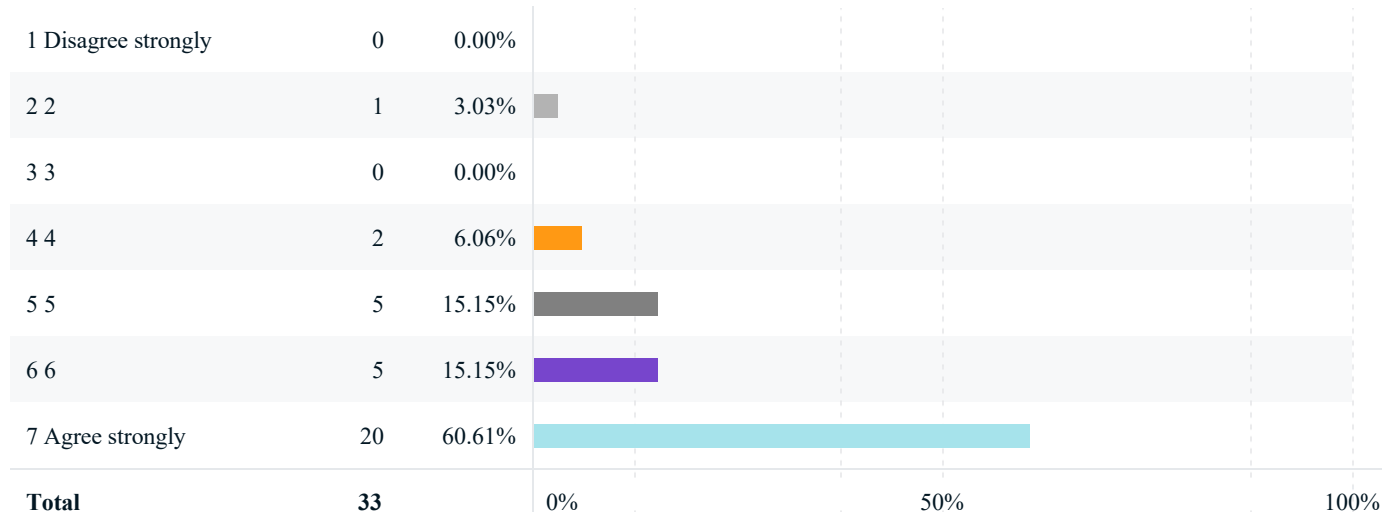
Statistics	Value
Mean	6.30
Median	7.00
Standard Deviation	1.19

3. The teaching assistant(s) was well prepared.



Statistics	Value
Mean	6.61
Median	7.00
Standard Deviation	0.83

4. The teaching assistant(s)' general instruction helped me work on the problem sets effectively.



Statistics	Value
Mean	6.21
Median	7.00
Standard Deviation	1.22